

Architecture in Ancient India

***Khajuraho temple** evidences the excellence of **Chandela** architecture. These temples are located in Chhatarpur district of Madhya Pradesh. They were built between 10th - 12th centuries. **Kandariya Mahadev Temple** may be built by Vidyadhar (11th century) is the best among these temples. There is a description of the construction of 85 temples in Khajuraho. *These temples are related to the Vaishnava, Shaiva, Shakta and Jainism in ancient India. ***Matangeshvara temple** of Khajuraho is dedicated to Lord Shiva. This temple was built during King Dhanga's empire. These temples were constructed in Nagara style. ***Parshvanath temple** is famous among Jain temples. The other temples here are -Chausath Yogini, Brahma, Lalguan Mahadev, Lakshmana, Vishvanath Temple, etc. ***Khajuraho temples, Bhimbetka rock shelters and Sanchi Stupa** are listed among the UNESCO World Heritage Sites in India.

***Ajanta and Bagh caves** are the examples of cave paintings during Gupta period. Ajanta Caves are located in Chhatrapati Sambhaji Nagar district of Maharashtra. An earlier group of these caves was built during the Satavahana period and later a major part of the caves was made during the Vakataka period. *The stone carvings are seen as a masterpiece in India. *Cave 16 has an important painted theme depicted and cave 17 had a well-preserved painting of Vakataka age that includes a huge gigantic wheel representing the "Wheel of Life."

*The paintings of **Bodhisattva Padmapani** are one of the most famous art structures in the cave I of Ajanta. Padmapani in Sanskrit literally translates to "one who holds the lotus". The Bodhisattva Padmapani sits among a crowd of devotees, both princesses and commoners with long, dark hair flowing down below a jewelled crown. He stands holding his attribute, a blue lotus flower in his right hand.

* **Vimal Vasahi temple**, most famous among **Dilwara Jain temple** of Mount Abu was built by **Vimal Shah** who was the feud of Chalukya (Solanki) ruler **Bheemdev -I**. This Jain temple is famous for its extraordinary architecture and marvellous marble stone carvings. *The **Palitana temple** of Jainism is located on Shatrunjaya hill near the city of Palitana in Bhavnagar district, Gujarat.

***Elephanta caves** are believed to have been built by the Rashtrakuta dynasty. This island consists of two groups of caves – the first is a large group of five **Hindu caves**, the second one includes a smaller group of two **Buddhist caves**. The caves are considered to be from the 5th to 6th century AD. *The statue of the famous **Trinity Shiva** can be found here.

***Ellora** is located in Chhatrapati Sambhaji Nagar district of Maharashtra. This is world-famous for rock cave temples. There are a total of 34 rock caves here. These caves belong to different periods and among them, 1 to 12 belong to **Buddhists**, 13 to

29 to **Hindus** and 30 to 34 to **Jains**, which were made at some years apart from one another. ***Kailasa temple** of Ellora is an example of rock-cut architecture. Rashtrakuta ruler **Krishna-I** built this temple in Dravidian style. *Nasik caves of Nasik are also known as '**Pandavleni**'.

*Rashtrakuta kings also patronized followers of the Shaiva, Vaishnava and Shakta faiths but they were inclined towards Jainism since many of the scholars who flourished in their courts and wrote in Sanskrit, Kannada and a few in Apabhramsha and in Prakrit were Jains. ***King Amoghavarsha - I** was the disciple of the Jain Acharya Jinasena, the author of Adipurana.

***Konark Sun Temple** is a 13th Century Sun Temple in Odisha, built by King Narasimhadeva –I. It was conceived as a huge solar chariot with **twelve pairs** of exquisitely ornamental wheels dragged by **seven rearing horses**. The monument is also called **Black Pagoda**.

***Lingaraj Temple** is one of the most popular temples of Odisha. The temple is dedicated to **Lord Shiva**, who is also known as Lingaraj. *Lingaraj temple is approximately 180 ft. in height and enshrines a huge statue of Lord Shiva. This temple is one of the finest examples of Nagara architecture. ***Jagan-nath Temple** is located in Puri district of Odisha State. This temple is made in **Nagara style**. ***Sun Temple of Modhera** is located in Gujarat. It was constructed by King Bhimadeva-I of Solanki dynasty.

***Angkor Wat** is a temple complex in the Southeast Asian nation Kampuchea (now Cambodia) built by Khmer King Suryavarman-II at the beginning of 12th Century in his capital Yashodhara Pura (present Angkor). Devoted to **Lord Vishnu**, it is the largest group of Hindu temples built in Khmer Style Architecture. ***Borobudur's** famous stupa is located on the Java island of Indonesia. It is a World Heritage Site declared by UNESCO.

*Temples were built in Dravidian style during the reign of Pandyas. In this period, the temples were small but ramparts were made around their premises. These ramparts were common, but their gateways which were called 'Gopurams', were elegant and spacious and were embellished with abundant craftsmanship. *Narasimha Varman-I (Mahamalla) (640-674 AD) was one of the most famous Pallava kings and **Mamalla style** was developed during his tenure. Narasimha was a good wrestler. The city of **Mamallapuram** was named after him. **Seven Ratha Temple** was built by Narasimha Varman-I which is adorned with seven rock-cut pagodas.

*Mahabalipuram (Mamallapuram) is situated on the seashore about 55 km south of Chennai, is well known for its architectural beauty and is recognized as a world heritage monument by the UNESCO. **Shore Temple**, Rathas (Chariots) carved out of a single rock, Arjuna's penance and other cave temples are some of the famous wonders. Mahabalipuram was a place of pilgrimage even before the Pallava period. Mahabalipuram was

a famous center of Pallava art and architecture. ***Draupadi Rath** is the smallest rath in monolithic temples or rath constructed in Mamalla style in Pallava period. There is no ornamentation found. It is pinned over lions and elephant-like sculptures.

*The **Koranganath Temple** of Srinivasanallur was built during the period of Chola ruler Parantaka- I. *Construction of **Rajarajeshwara** and **Brihadeeswara** Temple in Thanjavur was done during the era of Raja Raja- I. Granite stones have been used in its construction. *During the reign of Rajaraja's son Rajendra Chola, the temple was constructed at Gangaikonda Cholapuram. ***Sonagiri** is located 15 km away from Datia (M.P). Sonagiri is a sacred place popular among Digambar Jain devotees and ascetics to practice self-discipline, austerity and to attain Nirvana. There are 103 Jain temples with sky-high spires. Temple No.57 is main among them which is related to Lord Chandraprabhu. *The **Virupaksha temple** is located at Hampi in Karnataka State. This temple is named after Lord Shiva, known as Virupaksha here.

*The **Nagara, Dravida** and **Vesara** are the three main styles of temple architecture. **Nagara style** is prevalent throughout North India. The temples of Odisha are purely of this style. *The **Dravidian style** was spread in South India, especially between the Krishna River and Cape Comorin (Tamil Nadu). *The development of a **Vesara** happened from the mixture of Nagara and Dravidian styles. This style is also called the **Chalukya style** because it was used by the last Chalukya rulers.

*The famous **Naimisharanya** is located in **Sitapur** district of Uttar Pradesh. It is believed that Sage **Dadhichi** gladly gave up his bones to the Gods here. The bone of Sage Dadhichi was used to make the weapon (Vajra). This weapon was then used by Lord Indra to defeat the Asuras.

1. The associates of Khajuraho Temple Architecture were –
 (a) Chandela (b) Gurjara-Pratihara
 (c) Chahamana (d) Paramara

43rd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1999

M.P.P.S.C. (Pre) 1993

Ans. (a)

Khajuraho temple proves the excellence of Chandela architecture. These temples are located in Chhatarpur district of Madhya Pradesh. They were built between 10th-12th centuries. Kandariya Mahadev temple is the best among these temples.

2. The Temple of Kandariya Mahadev at Khajuraho was built by –

- (a) Parmara (b) Chedi
 (c) Rashtrakuta (d) Chandela

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1991

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of above question.

3. Which dynasty gave India its famous temples of Khajuraho?

- (a) Parmar (b) Mauryas
 (c) Chandelas (d) Holkars

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2005

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2010

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

4. The rulers of Chandela built–

- (a) Sanchi (b) Ujjain
 (c) Gwalior (d) Khajuraho

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of above question.

5. The temples of Khajuraho are related to –

- (a) Buddhist religion (b) Hindu religion
 (c) Hindu and Jain (d) Jain religion

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1993

Ans. (c)

Khajuraho is a group of Hindu and Jain temples in Madhya Pradesh. Most of these were built between 10th-12th centuries A.D. by Chandela dynasty. According to historical records, there were 85 temples built at the site of Khajuraho.

6. The temples of Khajuraho were built by the rulers of which of the following dynasties?

- (a) Baghel (b) Parmar
 (c) Chandel (d) Bundela

M.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2014

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

7. Matangesvara Temple at Khajuraho is dedicated to

- (a) Vishnu (b) Shiva
 (c) Surya (d) Parvati

U.P.P.S.C. (GIC) 2010

Ans. (b)

Matangeshvara Temple of Khajuraho is dedicated to Lord Shiva. This temple was built during King Dhanga's reign. These temples were constructed in Nagara architecture.

8. Which of the following temples is not located at Khajuraho?

- (a) Kandariya Mahadev (b) Chausath Yogini
 (c) Dashavatara (d) Chitragupta

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2010

Ans. (c)

Dashavatar Temple is located in Devgarh (Lalitpur), built during Gupta period. Rest in options are located in Khajuraho, built by Chandelas.

9. With reference to Chausath Yogini Temple situated near Morena, consider the following statements :

1. It is a circular temple built during the reign of Kachchhapaghata Dynasty
2. It is the only circular temple built in India.
3. It was meant to promote the Vaishnava cult in the region.
4. Its design has given rise to a popular belief that it was the inspiration behind the Indian Parliament building.

Select the correct answer using the code given below.

- (a) 1 and 2 (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 4 (d) 2, 3 and 4

I.A.S. (Pre.) 2021

Ans (c)

The Chausath Yogini temple is in Morena district (M.P.). According to an inscription dated to 1323 CE (Vikram Samvat 1383), the temple was built by the Kachchhapaghata king Devapala. Hence, statement 1 is correct. The uniqueness of this Yogini temple is its circular shape that is popularly believed to have inspired the design of the Indian Parliament. The circular shape is likely to have represented a Sri Yantra in which the Yoginis reside, with the Supreme Yogini or Maha Sakti residing in the centre (represented by the circular central main shrine). It is not the only circular temple built in India. Hence statements 2 and 3 are not correct and statement 4 is correct. Hence option (c) is the correct answer.

10. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer from the codes given below :

List-I	List-II
A. Stupa	1. Bagh
B. Painting	2. Sanchi
C. Headless statue of Kanishka	3. Deogarh
D. Dashavatara Temple	4. Mathura

Codes :

A	B	C	D
(a) 1	2	3	4
(b) 2	1	4	3
(c) 4	3	2	1
(d) 3	2	1	4

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Mains) 2017

Ans. (b)

The correctly matched list is as follows -

List-I	List-II
Stupa	Sanchi (M.P.)
Painting	Bagh (M.P.)
Headless statue of Kanishka	Mathura (U.P.)
Dashavatara Temple	Deogarh (U.P.)

11. Which of the following is not a world heritage site –

- (a) Khajuraho temples (b) Bhimbetka rock shelters
(c) Sanchi stupa (d) Mandu fort

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (d)

Khajuraho temples, Bhimbetka rock shelters and Sanchi stupa are listed among the UNESCO World Heritage Sites in India. Mandu fort is not listed as the World Heritage Site.

12. Which of the following statements about Temple Architecture are true?

- (i) The freestanding (mortar & Stone) temples are supposed to have originated in the Gupta period.
(ii) Ladkhan, which is one of the earliest temples belongs to Chalukya of Badami.
(iii) In Khajuraho temples, all the compartments of the temple are connected internally and externally.
(iv) Kailashnath temple at Kanchi is the earliest freestanding temple of Dravid style.

Choose the correct answer :

- (a) (i), (iii) and (iv) (b) (i) and (ii)
(c) (i), (ii) and (iv) (d) (i), (ii) and (iii)

[R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre)-2018]

Ans. (d)

The freestanding temples are supposed to have originated in the Gupta period. Ladkhan, which is one of the earliest temples belongs to Chalukya of Badami. In Khajuraho temples all the compartments of the temple are connected internally and externally. Kailashnath temple at Kanchi was built by Pallavas. It is a beautiful example of Dravida style of temple architecture built by Narsimhavarman-II (Rajasimha) and later completed by his son Mahendra Verman II. Therefore it can not be considered as earliest freestanding temple of Dravida style.

13. The pinnacle of which of the following is built in Dravida style?

- (a) Bhitargaon Temple
(b) Teli Temple of Gwalior
(c) Kandaria Mahadeo Temple
(d) Osia Temple

U.P. R.O./ A.R.O. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (b)

Teli Temple of Gwalior presents a perfect fusion of the Nagara and Dravidian architectural styles of India. The Shikhar (pinnacle) of the temple is Dravidian in style, whereas the ornamentation is done in the Nagara style.

14. Which of the following temple is an example of Vesara style of architecture?

- (a) Hoysaleswara Temple
(b) Kandariya Mahadeva Temple

- (c) Sri Rama Temple Ayodhya
(d) None of the above

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (a)

The Hoysaleswara temple (Lord of the Hoysalas) at Halebidu in Karnataka was built in dark schist stone by the Hoysala king. Hoysala temples are sometimes called hybrid or Vesara as their unique style seems neither completely Dravida nor Nagara, but somewhere in between. They are easily distinguishable from other medieval temples by their highly original star-like ground-plans and a profusion of decorative carvings.

15. Which centre consists of more than 100 Buddha caves?

- (a) Ajanta (b) Karley
(c) Kanheri (d) Rajgrih

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2002

Ans. (c)

The Kanheri caves constitute a group of rock-cut monuments that are located to the north of Borivali on the western outskirts of Mumbai. The Kanheri caves demonstrate Buddhist influence on the art and culture of India built during 1st century BC.

16. Jain temple of Abu is made of –

- (a) Sandstone (b) Limestone
(c) Granite (d) Marble

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2010

Ans. (d)

Jain Temple of Abu is one of the most elegant Jain temples known world over for its extraordinary architecture and marvellous marble stone carvings. This temple was built by Vimal Shah who was the feudatory of the then Chalukya ruler of Gujarat, Bheemdev - I.

17. Palitana temple is located near –

- (a) Bhavnagar (b) Mount Abu
(c) Nasik (d) Ujjain

I.A.S. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (a)

The Palitana temple of Jainism is located on Shatrunjaya hill near the city of Palitana in Bhavnagar district, Gujarat. This temple is dedicated to the 1st Jain Tirthankara Adinatha.

18. The Elephanta caves were mainly sculptured for which of the following devotees?

- (a) Buddhist (b) Jain
(c) Shaiva (d) Vaishnava

U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2003

U.P. Lower Sub. (Spl) (Pre) 2002

Ans. (c)

Elephanta caves are believed to have been built by the Rashtrakuta dynasty. This island is located on an arm of the Arabian Sea, and consists of two groups of caves—the first is a large group of five Hindu caves, and the second one includes a smaller group of two Buddhist caves. The Hindu caves contain rock-cut stone sculptures, that represent the Shaiva Hindu sect, and are dedicated to Lord Shiva. The Trimurti of Elephanta showing the three faces of Shiva is akin to the trinity of Brahma, Vishnu and Mahesh (Shiva), which was the royal insignia of the Rashtrakutas.

19. The ancient monuments of Elephanta are mostly

1. Buddhist 2. Jain
3. Shaivite 4. Vaishnavite

Select the correct answer from the codes given below :

Code :

- (a) 1 (b) 2
(c) 3 (d) 1 and 3

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2007

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of above question.

20. Famous cave temples of Elephanta are ascribed to

- (a) Chalukyas (b) Cholas
(c) Pallavas (d) Rashtrakutas

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2010

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2009

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of above question.

21. To which period do the sites of Ellora and Elephanta belong?

- (a) Pratihara (b) Chalukyas
(c) Rashtrakuta (d) Hoysalas

M.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (c)

Sites of Ellora and Elephanta belong to Rashtrakuta period. Ellora caves are related to Hindu, Jain and Buddha religions. Elephanta caves were constructed by Rashtrakuta rulers. Famous Trimurti Shiva statue is found from here.

22. Which of the following caves is famous for 'Trimurti'?

- (a) Ajanta (b) Bhaja
(c) Elephanta (d) Ellora

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2011

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

23. There are only two known examples of cave paintings of the Gupta period in ancient India. One of these is paintings of Ajanta caves. Where is the other surviving example of Gupta paintings?

- (a) Bagh caves (b) Elora caves
(d) Lomas Rishi caves (d) Nasik caves

I.A.S. (Pre) 2010

Ans. (a)

Another excellent example of cave painting during the Gupta period is Bagh caves. These cave paintings reflect normal public life. While Ajanta cave paintings belonged to Buddhist religion, Lomas Rishi caves are related to the Mauryan period, which is located in Barabar hills, Jahanabad district of Bihar, Nasik caves belong to Satavahana period.

24. The rock-cut caves in western India are located in –

- (a) Nasik, Ellora and Ajanta
(b) Junar, Kalyan and Pitalkhora
(c) Ajanta, Bhaja and Kondane
(d) Bhaja, Pitalkhora and Kondane

I.A.S. (Pre) 1993

Ans. (a)

The ancient rock-cut caves in western India are located at Nasik, Ellora and Ajanta. A total of 34 caves in Ellora are famous and related to Buddhists, Hindus and Jains. Nasik caves are also known as Pandavleni caves or Pundri Leni, representing Buddhist devotional practices.

25. Which of the following places is famous for Buddhist cave temples?

- (a) Elephanta (b) Nalanda
(c) Ajanta (d) Khajuraho

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Mains) 2006

Ans. (c)

Ajanta is famous for Buddhist cave temples while Elephanta is famous for its Shaiva temples, Khajuraho is known for Shaiva, Vaishnava and Jain temples and Nalanda is famous as a Buddhist education centre.

26. Ellora caves were built by –

- (a) Pallavas (b) Cholas
(c) Rashtrakutas (d) Palas

U.P.P.S.C. (GIC) 2010

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (c)

Rashtrakuta rulers built most of the Ellora caves.

27. With reference to the history of Indian rock-cut architecture, consider the following statements

1. The caves at Badami are the oldest surviving rock-cut caves in India,
 2. The Barabar rock-cut caves were originally made for Ajivikas by Emperor Chandragupta Maurya.
 3. At Ellora, caves were made for different faiths.
- Which of the statements given above is /are correct?

- (a) Only 1 (b) 2 and 3
(c) Only 3 (d) All of these

I.A.S. (Pre) 2013

Ans. (c)

The caves at Badami are not oldest surviving rock-cut caves in India, but Bhimbetka rock shelters are the oldest surviving rock-cut caves in India. Ashoka in his time period donated a cave to the Ajivikas in the Barabar Hills. Barabar Hill consists of four caves named Karan Chaupar, Lomas Rishi, Sudama and Vishva Zopari. Ellora caves were made for different faiths. In these caves, 12 belong to Buddhists, 17 belong to Hindus and 5 belong to Jains. Thus, statements 1 and 2 are wrong, while statement 3 is correct.

28. Ellora cave temples are related to–

1. Hinduism 2. Buddhism
3. Jainism

Choose right answer from codes:

- (a) only 1 (b) only 2
(c) 1 and 2 (d) 1, 2 and 3

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2002

Ans. (d)

Ellora caves, locally known as 'Verul Leni' are located 25 km away from Chhatrapati Sambhaji Nagar in Maharashtra. In total, there are 4 caves. Among them, 1 to 12 belong to Buddhists, caves 13 to 29 are devoted to Hindus and caves 30 to 34 belong to Jains.

29. The caves and rock-cut temples at Ellora represent only :

- (a) Buddhists
(b) Buddhists and Jains
(c) Hindus and Jains
(d) Hindus, Buddhists, and Jains

I.A.S. (Pre) 1994

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1998

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of above question.

30. Buddhist, Hindu and Jain rock-cut caves coexist at –

- (a) Ajanta (b) Elephanta
(c) Ellora (d) Karle

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2002

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2006

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

31. Which of the following temples is an example of rock-cut architecture?

- (a) Shore Temple, Mamallapuram.
(b) Rajarajeshwara Temple, Thanjavur.

- (c) Kailasa Temple, Ellora.
(d) Jagannatha Temple, Puri.

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2012

Ans. (c)

Kailasa temple of Ellora is an example of rock-cut architecture. Rashtrakuta ruler Krishna-I built this temple in Dravidian style.

32. Among the cave temples, where is the famous Kailasa temple located?

- (a) In the caves of Ajanta
(b) In the caves of Ellora
(c) In the caves of Elephanta
(d) In the caves of Kanheri

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2024

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of above question.

33. Which of the following temples is considered as a wonder of rock-cut architecture ?

- (a) Brihadeeswara Temple, Tanjavur
(b) Lingaraja Temple, Bhubaneswar
(c) Kailasa Temple, Ellora
(d) Kandaria Mahadeva Temple, Khajuraho

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2007

Ans. (c)

Kailasa (cave 16 of Ellora) is a remarkable example of Dravidian architecture on account of its striking proportion, elaborate workmanship, architectural content and sculptural ornamentation of rock-cut architecture. The temple was built by Krishna I of Rashtrakuta dynasty. It is designed to recall Mount Kailasa, the home of Lord Shiva.

34. Which dynasty constructed the Ellora Kailasa Temple?

- (a) Rashtrakuta (b) Satvahana
(c) Maurya (d) Pallava

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2005

U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2001

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of above question.

35. The Kailasa temple of Ellora was built by –

- (a) Rashtrakutas
(b) Chalukyas of Vatapi
(c) Ganga Rulers
(d) None of the above

U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (Spl) (Mains) 2010

U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (Spl) (Pre) 2010

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of above question.

36. Which among the following Rashtrakuta ruler built the Kailas temple of Ellora?

- (a) Govind-II (b) Amoghavarsha
(c) Indra-III (d) Krishna-I

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of above question.

37. Which dynasty of rulers is associated with the construction of famous the Kailasa Temple of Ellora?

- (a) Chalukyas (b) Cholas
(c) Pallavas (d) Rashtrakutas

U.P. Lower Sub. (Spl) (Pre) 2008

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2004

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of above question.

38. Which Rashtrakuta ruler built the famous Shiva temple of Ellora?

- (a) Dantidurga (b) Krishna- I
(c) Krishna- II (d) Govind- III

R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of above question.

39. Kailasa temple of Ellora was constituted by

- (a) Govind- III (b) Krishna- I
(c) Krishna- II (d) Krishna- III
(e) None of these

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of above question.

40. Which religion had Rashtrakuta protection?

- (a) Buddha (b) Jain
(c) Shaiva (d) Shakta

U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2010

Ans. (b)

Rashtrakuta kings patronized followers of the Shaiva, Vaishnava and Shakta faiths but they were inclined towards Jainism since many of the scholars who flourished in their courts and wrote in Sanskrit, Kannada and a few in Apabhramsha and Prakrit were Jains. King Amoghavarsha - I was the disciple of the Jain Acharya Jinasena the author of Adipurana.

41. Caves of Ajanta and Ellora are located in–

- (a) Nasik (b) Mumbai
(c) Aurangabad (d) Pune

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1990

Ans. (c)

The caves of Ajanta and Ellora are located in the Chhatrapati Sambhaji Nagar (formerly Aurangabad) district of Maharashtra. The Kailasa temple of Ellora is the finest example of rock-cut art, which was built by Rashtrakutas.

42. The caves of Ajanta and Ellora are in -

- (a) Andhra Pradesh (b) Madhya Pradesh
(c) Maharashtra (d) Rajasthan

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1993

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

43. In which one of the following places, are the cave temples built by the Rashtrakutas in the Ellora mountains located?

- (a) Aurangabad (Maharashtra)
(b) Nasik (Maharashtra)
(c) Gwalior (Madhya Pradesh)
(d) Golconda (Andhra Pradesh)

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2009

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of above question.

44. Match List – I with List – II and select the correct answer from the codes given below:

List – I (Gupta Temple)	List – II (Location)
A. Brick-built Temple	1. Eran
B. Dashavatara Temple	2. Deogarh
C. Shiva Temple	3. Bhitargaon
D. Vishnu Temple	4. Bhumara

Code :

	A	B	C	D
(a)	4	2	1	3
(b)	3	2	4	1
(c)	2	1	3	4
(d)	1	3	2	4

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2013

Ans. (b)

The correctly matched pairs are-

Brick-built Temple	-	Bhitargaon
Dashavatara Temple	-	Deogarh
Shiva Temple	-	Bhumara
Vishnu Temple	-	Eran

Hence, option (b) is the correct answer.

45. The temple of Deogarh near Jhansi and the sculptures in the temple at Garhwa near Allahabad are the important remains of the

- (a) Maurya art
(b) Gupta art
(c) Rashtrakuta art
(d) More than one of the above

(e) None of the above

68th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (b)

Dashavata temple, Deogarh (Lalitpur) near Jhansi is a temple of Gupta period and is earliest known Panchayatan temple in North India.

Garhwa fort is a temple complex in Shankargarh, Prayagraj belonging to Gupta period.

46. The temple at Deogarh near Jhansi and the sculptures in the temple at Garhwa near Allahabad are important remains of

- (a) Rashtrakuta art (b) Gupta art
(c) Maurya art (d) None of the above

70th B.P.S.C. Re-Exam 2024

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of above question.

47. With reference to the temple of Bhitargaon, Kanpur, Uttar Pradesh, which of the following statements is/are correct?

(1) This temple was constructed during 5th century A.D. to 6th century A.D.

(2) It is one of the oldest brick temples of India.

Select the correct answer using the code given below-
Code :

- (a) Only 1 (b) Only 2
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

[U.P.RO/ARO (Pre)-2021]

Ans. (c)

The Bhitargaon temple is a terraced brick building fronted with a terracotta panel. It was constructed during 5th century A.D. to 6th century A.D. during Gupta period. It is one of the oldest brick temples of India. It is built on a square plan with double-recessed corners and faces east. There is a tall pyramidal spire over the garbhagriha. It is built in 'Nagara Style' of architecture.

48. The art of Ajanta was mainly patronized by the –

- (a) Chalukyas (b) Pallavas
(c) Vakatakas (d) Gangas

Jharkhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2013

Ans. (c)

Ajanta Caves are located in Chhatrapati Sambhaji Nagar district of Maharashtra. An earlier group of these caves were built during the Satavahana period and later a major part of the caves were made during the Vakataka period. These stone carvings are seen as a work of masterpiece in India. In Ajanta caves, exquisite carvings were done out of the mountain rock. These are the cave temples of Buddha and have mystical figures of the Lord and others.

49. Ajanta caves are linked with –

- (a) Ramayana (b) Mahabharata
(c) Jataka stories (d) Panchatantra stories

Ans. (c)

Ajanta caves are the most excellent surviving examples of Indian art, particularly the paintings which are the masterpieces of Buddhist religious art, with the figures of Buddha and depictions of the Jataka stories, the paintings concentrate on those Jataka stories which show the previous life of Buddha as a king. Technically, the art of Ajanta is the finest surviving example of Indian art. The cave consists of several arts, such as flowers, trees and animals. The paintings concentrate on the previous life of Buddha as a king.

50. Which one of the following statements is correct?

- (a) Ajanta Caves lie in the gorge of Waghora river.
- (b) Sanchi Stupa lies in the gorge of Chambal river.
- (c) Pandu-lena Cave Shrines lie in the gorge of Narmada river.
- (d) Amaravati Stupa lies in the gorge of Godavari river.

I.A.S. (Pre)-2021

Ans. (a)

Ajanta cave is located in Chhatrapati Sambhaji Nagar district of Maharashtra province. This cave is situated in the valley of the Waghora river. Hence option (a) is true. Sanchi stupa was built by Maurya emperor Ashoka. It lies west of Betwa river in the Raisen district of Madhya Pradesh. Pandu-lena cave shrines are situated in Nashik, Maharashtra and lie in the valley of Godavari river. Amravati Stupa is a ruined Buddhist Stupa at the village of Amravati, Palnadu district, Andhra Pradesh. Village is situated on the banks of Krishna river.

51. Consider the following historical places :

1. Ajanta Caves
2. Lepakshi Temple
3. Sanchi Stupa

Which of the above places is/are also known for mural paintings?

- (a) Only 1
- (b) Only 1 and 2
- (c) 1, 2 and 3
- (d) None

I.A.S. (Pre) 2013

Ans. (b)

The evidence of mural painting in Ajanta and Lepakshi temple is clearly visible, but it is not evident in Sanchi Stupa. The nucleus of Sanchi Stupa was a simple hemispherical brick structure built over the relics of the Buddha. It was crowned by the Chhatra, a parasol-like structure symbolising high rank, which was intended to honour and shelter the relics.

52. Buddhist caves are not situated in which of the following places?

- (a) Ajanta
- (b) Bagh
- (c) Sanchi
- (d) Bulsar

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (c&d)

Buddhist caves are not situated in Sanchi and Bulsar. The Bagh caves also feature Buddhist art. Ajanta caves contain beautiful paintings and sculptures, depicting the life and teachings of Buddha.

53. Consider the following statements related to the folk paintings of India and choose the correct answer :

Statement I : The themes of Pattachitra paintings are inspired from Jagannath and Vaishnav Cults

Statement II : Manjusha paintings are executed on boxes of jute and paper

Statement III : Pithora paintings are made by some tribal communities of Gujarat and Madhya Pradesh

- (a) Only Statement I and II are correct
- (b) Only Statement II and III are correct
- (c) Only Statement I and III are correct
- (d) All the four statements are correct

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre)-2020

Ans. (*)

The art of Pattachitra belongs to state of Odisha and is closely connected to the Lord Jagannath and Vaishnav cults. Manjusha art is a folk arts of Bhagalpur, Bihar and is one of the oldest painting art of India. Manjushas are temple shaped boxes comprising eight pillars. These are made of bamboo, jute and paper and are painted using only three colors - Pink, Green and Yellow. These boxes are used in Bishahari Puja. Pithora painting is a ritualistic painting practiced by the tribes in Gujarat and Madhya Pradesh. In option (d) four statements are given but only three statements are there. So it can not be correct.

54. What is/are common to the two historical places known as Ajanta and Mahabalipuram?

1. Both were built in the same period.
2. Both belong to the same religious denomination.
3. Both have rock-cut monuments.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below.

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 3 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only
- (d) None of the statements given above is correct

I.A.S. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (b)

Mahabalipuram (Mamallapuram) is located on the hillock town, overlooking the Coromandel coast of Bay of Bengal in Chengalpattu district of Tamil Nadu. It is also called 'Mahadapas' Rock Cut Caves. It was established during 7th to the 10th century of Pallava dynasty. Whereas Ajanta Caves in Chhatrapati Sambhaji Nagar district of Maharashtra including 30 rock-cut caves were built in 2nd century B.C. to 7th century AD. Thus, neither was built in the same period. So, statement (1) is wrong. Both Ajanta and Mahabalipuram are rock cut-monuments. So, statement (3) is correct. Mahabalipuram Monuments are related to Shiva or Vishnu whereas Ajanta has series of 29 Buddhist Cave Temples. Thus, statement (2) is also incorrect.

55. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer from the codes given below:

List - I	List - II
A. Hampi	1. Puducherry
B. Nagarjunakonda	2. Karnataka
C. Shishupalgarh	3. Andhra Pradesh
D. Arikamedu	4. Odisha

Code :

	A	B	C	D
(a)	2	3	4	1
(b)	3	2	4	1
(c)	1	3	2	4
(d)	4	2	3	1

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2014

Ans. (a)

The correctly matched pairs are–		
Hampi	-	Karnataka
Nagarjunakonda	-	Andhra Pradesh
Shishupalgarh	-	Odisha
Arikamedu	-	Puducherry

56. Who built the Konark Sun Temple?

- (a) Narasimhadeva Varman
- (b) Rajendra Chola
- (c) Ashoka
- (d) Krishnadev Rai

R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) 1999

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1995

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1993

Ans. (a)

Konarka Sun Temple is a 13th-century Sun Temple in Odisha, India, built by King Narasimhadeva Varman-I of Eastern Ganga Dynasty. It was conceived as a huge solar chariot with twelve pairs of exquisitely ornamental wheels dragged by seven rearing horses. The monument was also called as Black Pagoda by European sailors. In contrast, the Jagannath Temple in Puri was called the White Pagoda.

57. Which among these is known as 'Black Pagoda'?

- (a) Shore Temple
- (b) Khajuraho Temple
- (c) Konark Sun Temple
- (d) Deogarh Temple

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2009

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

58. Where is 'Black Pagoda'?

- (a) Madurai
- (b) Konark
- (c) Khajuraho
- (d) None of the above

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2010

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of above question.

59. Which one of the following is a Sun temple ?

- (a) Lingaraj temple
- (b) Rajarani temple
- (c) Konark temple
- (d) Jagannath temple

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2006

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

60. The Sun Temple of Modhera lies in which state?

- (a) Bihar
- (b) Gujarat
- (c) Odisha
- (d) Bengal

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (b)

The Sun Temple of Modhera is in Gujarat. King Bhimadeva-I of Solanki dynasty built this temple.

61. Which one of the following Sun Temples is located in Patan, Gujarat?

- (a) Modhera
- (b) Dakshinark
- (c) Konark
- (d) Martand

R.A.S./R.A.S. (Pre) 1992

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of above question.

62. Lingaraj Temple is located at –

- (a) Bhubaneswara
- (b) Bijapur
- (c) Kolkata
- (d) Varanasi

U.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Mains) 2004

I.A.S. (Pre) 2001

Ans. (a)

Lingaraja Temple is one of the most popular temples of Odisha. The temple is dedicated to Lord Shiva who is also known as Lingraj. Lingaraj temple is approximately 180 ft. in height and enshrines a huge statue of Lord Shiva. This temple is built in Nagara architectural style and is one of the most excellent examples of this architectural form.

63. Which among the following is the largest and the tallest surviving temple in Orissa?

- (a) Brahmesvara Temple
- (b) Jagannath Temple
- (c) Lingaraja Temple
- (d) Rajarani Temple

U.P.S.C. (GIC) 2010

Ans. (c)

Lingaraj temple of Odisha is the largest and tallest temple among the given options. It is approximately 180 ft. in height.

64. Jagannath temple is located in state of –

- (a) Bengal
- (b) Orissa
- (c) Kerala
- (d) Uttar Pradesh

M.P. P.S.C. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (b)

Jagannath temple (Puri) is located in Orissa (Odisha) state. The famous Lingaraj temple (Bhubaneswara) and Konarka Sun Temple (Puri) are also in Odisha, built in Nagara style.

65. The Temple of Bhubaneswara and Puri was built in:

- (a) Nagara style (b) Dravidian style
(c) Besara style (d) None of the above

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of above question.

66. The idols of Lord Jagannath, Subhadra and Balbhadr in sanctum sanctorum at Jagannath Puri Temple are made up of –

- (a) Stone (b) Metal
(c) Wood (d) Glass

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (c)

The idols of Lord Jagannatha, Subhadra and Balbhadr in Sanctum Sanctorum are made of neem wood. Neem wood is chosen because the Bhavishya Purana declares it to be the most auspicious wood from which to make Lord Vishnu idols. The wood icon is repainted every year before the Ratha-yatra. It is replaced with a newly carved image every 12 or 19 years approximately or more precisely according to the Luni-solar Hindu calendar when its month of Asadha occurs twice in the same year.

67. Angkor Wat Vishnu Temple is located in :

- (a) Java (b) Sumatra
(c) Cambodia (d) Champa

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1995

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1992

Ans. (c)

Angkor Wat is a temple complex in south-east Asian nation of Kampuchea (now Cambodia) built by Khmer King Suryavarman - II in the beginning of 12th century in his capital Yashodhara Pura (present Angkor). Devoted to Lord Vishnu, it is the largest group of Hindu temples built in the Khmer style of architecture.

68. In which country is the “Angkor-Wat Temple” complex located?

- (a) Indonesia (b) Myanmar
(c) Sri Lanka (d) Kampuchea

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of above question.

69. The initial design and construction of which massive temple took place during the reign of Suryavarman- II?

- (a) Sri Mariamman Temple
(b) Angkor Wat Temple
(c) Batu Caves Temple
(d) Kamakhya Temple

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1993

I.A.S. (Pre) 2006

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of above question.

70. Where is Borobudur Stupa situated ?

- (a) Cambodia (b) Java
(c) Sumatra (d) Borneo

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2013

Ans. (b)

The famous stupa of Borobudur is located on Java Island of Indonesia. This is a world heritage site declared by UNESCO.

71. ‘Gopuram’ the temples of Dravidian style stands for :

- (a) Sanctuary
(b) Paintings on the walls
(c) Pinnacle
(d) Ornamental and multi-storied structures upon the gateways.

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1998

Ans. (d)

Gopuram is a monumental tower, usually ornate at the entrance of any temple, especially in southern India. This forms a prominent feature of Hindu temples of the Dravidian style. The gopuram's origin can be traced back to early structures of the Tamil kings Pallavas and by the twelfth century under the Pandya rulers. These gateways became a dominant feature of a temple's outer appearance, eventually overshadowing the inner sanctuary which became hidden from the view by the gopuram's enormous size.

72. Rock-cut temples of Mahabalipuram were built by :

- (a) Pallavas (b) Cholas
(c) Chalukyas (d) Rashtrakutas

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (a)

Mahabalipuram (Mamallapuram) is well known for its architectural beauty and is recognized as a world heritage monument by the UNESCO. Shore temple, Rathas (Chariots) carved out of a single rock, Arjuna penance and other cave temples are some of the famous wonders. Mahabalipuram (Mamallapuram) was a place of pilgrimage even before the Pallava period and the Pallava king Narasimha Varman built these beautiful temples, including the present Shore temple. Mahabalipuram (Mamallapuram) was a famous center of Pallava art and architecture.

73. The Rath temples at Mahabalipuram were built by

- (a) Cholas (b) Pallavas
(c) Chedis (d) Chalukyas

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2014

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of above question.

74. The Seven Ratha Temple of Mahabalipuram was built by –
 (a) Mahendra Varman (b) Narasimha Varman
 (c) Parmeshwar Varman (d) Nandi Varman

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2015

Ans. (b)

Narasimha Varman-I (630-668 AD) was one of the most famous Pallava kings and Mamalla style was developed during his tenure. Narasimha was a good wrestler. The city of Mamallapuram was named after him. Seven Ratha Temple was built by Narshimha Varman-I which is adorned with seven rock-cut pagodas.

75. Who constructed the Ratha Temples at Mahabalipuram?
 (a) Narasingh Varman-I (b) Samudragupta
 (c) Harsha (d) Pulakesin-II

Uttarakhand U.D.A./L.D.A. (Mains) 2007

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of above question.

76. Who among the following was responsible for the creation of Ratha monuments at Mamallapuram?

- (a) Cholas (b) Pallavas
 (c) Pandyas (d) Chalukyas

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2007

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of above question.

77. Which of the following Rath temples is the smallest?
 (a) Draupadi Rath (b) Bhima Rath
 (c) Arjun Rath (d) Dharmaraj Rath

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2011

Ans. (a)

Draupadi Rath is the smallest rath in monolithic temples or rath constructed in Mamalla style in Pallava period. There is no ornamentation found. It is pinned over lions and elephant-like sculptures.

78. In which style is the Kailasanathar Temple of Kanchi built?

- (a) Rajsimha Style (b) Mamalla Style
 (c) Mahendra Style (d) Nandivarman Style

M.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2025

Ans. (a)

The Kailasanathar Temple of Kanchipuram is located in Kanchipuram, Tamil Nadu, and was built by the Pallava king, Narasimhavarman II. The temple is constructed in the Rajsimha architectural style, characterized by intricate carvings, large Gopurams (temple towers) and stone sculptures with fine detailing and artistic beauty. The main deity of the temple is Lord Shiva.

79. Arrange the following temples in a chronological order and select the correct answer from the codes given below:

- (i) Brihdishwar temple
 (ii) Gangaikonda cholapuram temple
 (iii) Shore temple of Mahabalipuram
 (iv) Sapt pagoda

Codes :

- (a) I, II, IV, III (b) II, I, III, IV
 (c) III, II, I, IV (d) IV, III, I, II

[U.P. P.C.S. (Pre)-2018]

Ans. (d)

Correct order of construction of temples is —
 Sapt Pagoda (Mamall Style 640-674 AD), Shore Temple of Mahabalipuram (Rajsimha style 674-800 AD), Brihdeeshwara temple (during Rajraja-I period), and Gangaikonda Cholapuram temple (during Rajendra-I period).

80. Match List - I with List - II and select the correct answer using the codes given below the lists :

List - I (Place) List - II (Monument)

- A. Elephanta 1. Stupa
 B. Shravanabelagola 2. Temple
 C. Khajuraho 3. Cave
 D. Sanchi 4. Statue

Code :

- | | A | B | C | D |
|-----|---|---|---|---|
| (a) | 2 | 4 | 3 | 1 |
| (b) | 3 | 4 | 2 | 1 |
| (c) | 2 | 4 | 3 | 1 |
| (d) | 3 | 2 | 4 | 1 |

U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2001

Ans. (b)

The correctly matched pairs are :

- | | | |
|------------------|---|--------|
| Elephanta | - | Cave |
| Shravanabelagola | - | Statue |
| Khajuraho | - | Temple |
| Sanchi | - | Stupa |

81. Match List - I with List - II and select the correct answer using the codes given below the lists :

List - I (Historical Sites) List - II (States)

- A. Bhimbetka 1. Assam
 B. Shore temple 2. Madhya Pradesh
 C. Hampi 3. Tamil Nadu
 D. Manas 4. Karnataka

Code :

- | | A | B | C | D |
|-----|---|---|---|---|
| (a) | 2 | 1 | 3 | 4 |
| (b) | 2 | 3 | 4 | 1 |
| (c) | 1 | 3 | 4 | 2 |
| (d) | 4 | 2 | 3 | 1 |

Ans. (b)

The correctly matched pairs are :

Bhimbetka	-	Madhya Pradesh
Shore Temple	-	Tamil Nadu
Hampi	-	Karnataka
Manas	-	Assam

82. Which of the following pairs is correctly matched?

- (a) Ellora Caves - Sakas
(b) Meenakshi Temple - Pallavas
(c) Khajuraho Temple - Chandelas
(d) Mahabalipuram Temple - Rashtrakutas

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2010

U. P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2008

I.A.S. (Pre) 2006

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1996

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (c)

Ellora Caves are located near Chhatrapati Sambhaji Nagar (Maharashtra). These are famous for rock-cut cave temples. Here, a total of 34 rock-cut caves are found. These caves were constructed in various periods but not associated with Sakas. Meenakshi Temple was constructed by Pandyas and Mahabalipuram Temple was built by Pallavas. Khajuraho temples were built by Chandelas. Therefore, option (c) is correctly matched.

83. Match List - I with List - II and choose the right answer from given codes:

List - I (Place)	List - II (Monument)
A. Baidyanath Dham	1. Jain Temple
B. Sarnath	2. Shiva Temple
C. Dilwara	3. First sermon place of Buddha
D. Badrinath	4. Vishnu Temple

Code :

	A	B	C	D
(a)	2	3	1	4
(b)	1	2	3	4
(c)	1	4	2	3
(d)	4	1	3	2

U.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Pre) 2004

Ans. (a)

Sarnath (Varanasi) is the place where Lord Buddha gave his first sermon (Dharmachakra Pravartan) to his five disciples. Dilwara temple of Rajasthan is famous for one of the most elegant Jain temples known worldwide for its extraordinary architecture and marvellous marble stone carvings. Shankaracharya established Badrinath with the statue of God Vishnu. Baidyanath Dham is a temple of God Shiva.

84. Consider the following pairs :

Site	Well known for
1. Besnagar	Shaivite cave shrine
2. Bhaja	Buddhist cave shrine
3. Sittanavasal	Jain cave shrine

How many of the above pairs are correctly matched?

- (a) Only one
(b) Only two
(c) All three
(d) None

I.A.S. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (b)

Evidence related to Bhagwat religion is available from Besnagar (Madhya Pradesh). The Garun Pillar was established here by the Greek ambassador Heliodorus. Hence statement 1 is wrongly matched. Bhaja Caves are one of the best examples of Buddhist architecture in India. It is located in Bhaje, a village in the Pune, Maharashtra. The Sittanavasal cave temple was built by the Pallava king Mahendravarman I for Jainism.

85. Match the following:

A. Sun Temple	1. Karnataka
B. Lingaraja Temple	2. Konark
C. Hawa Mahal	3. Jaipur
D. Statue of Gomateshwara	4. Bhubaneswar

Code :

	A	B	C	D
(a)	2	4	3	1
(b)	2	4	1	3
(c)	4	2	1	3
(d)	3	1	2	4

U.P. P.C.S (Pre) 1992

Ans. (a)

Sun temple is in Konark in Odisha. Lingaraja temple is a Hindu temple dedicated to Harihara a form of Shiva and is one of the oldest temples in Bhubaneswar, Hawa Mahal is in Jaipur, and the huge statue of Gomateshwara is in Shravanbelagola (Karnataka).

86. Which of the following is/are famous for Sun temples?

1. Arasavalli
2. Amarakantak
3. Omkareshwar

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- (a) 1 only
(b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3

I.A.S. (Pre) 2017

Ans. (a)

Arasavalli temple is one of the prominent sun temples of 7th century in Arasavalli village of Andhra Pradesh. It is believed that the temple was built by King Devendra Verma, ruler of the Eastern Ganga (Kalinga) Dynasty. Omkareshwar temple is situated in the Khandwa district of Madhya Pradesh. It

is on an island called Mandhata or Shivpuri situated on the Narmada river. It is one of the 12 Jyotirlinga Shrines of Shiva. Narmada, son and Johila rivers emerge from Amarkantak. Sri Jwaleshwar or Jaleswara Mahadev temple is located 8 km away from Amarkantak on Shahdol road. It is dedicated to Shiva.

87. Match list-I and list-II and select the correct answer from the given codes :

List-I	List-II
A. Nalanda	1. Ashoka Pillar
B. Sarnath	2. University
C. Sanchi	3. Sun Temple
D. Konarka	4. Stupa

Code :

	A	B	C	D
(a)	1	2	4	3
(b)	2	1	4	3
(c)	1	2	3	4
(d)	2	3	4	1

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Mains) 2006

Ans. (b)

The correctly matched pairs are as follows :

Nalanda	-	University
Sarnath	-	Pillar of Ashoka
Sanchi	-	Stupa
Konark	-	Sun Temple

So, option (b) is the correct.

88. Between which of the following was the ancient town of Takshashila located?

- (a) Indus and Jhelum (b) Jhelum and Chenab
(c) Chenab and Ravi (d) Ravi and Beas

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1996

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Mains) 2006

Ans. (a)

Takshashila was established during 6th or 7th century BC. It was a town and an important archaeological site in present day Rawalpindi district of Punjab, Pakistan. It is situated between the rivers Jhelum and Indus.

89. Sonagiri, the highest among 103 Jain temples, lies in the proximity of

- (a) Datia (b) Jhansi
(c) Orchha (d) Lalitpur

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (a)

Sonagiri is located 15 km away from Datia (MP). Sonagiri is a sacred place popular among Digambar Jain devotees and ascetic saints to practise for self-discipline, austerity and to attain Nirvana. There are 103 beautiful Jain temples with sky-high spires. Temple No. 57 is main among them which is related to Lord Chandrababhu.

90. The historical Digambar Jain temple of Sonagiri is in—

- (a) Uttar Pradesh (b) Rajasthan
(c) Madhya Pradesh (d) Odisha

U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

91. Dilwara Jain temple is situated at –

- (a) Palitana (b) Mount Abu
(c) Sonagiri (d) Girnar

U.P.P.C.S. (GIC) 2010

Ans. (b)

The Dilwara Jain temples are located at Mount Abu, Rajasthan.

92. Dilwara Jain temple is in—

- (a) Aravali mountain in Mount Abu
(b) On the bank of Indus
(c) Khajuraho
(d) Nilgiri Hills

M.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 1991

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of above question.

93. Where is the Dilwara Jain temple located?

- (a) Assam (b) Uttar Pradesh
(c) Rajasthan (d) Madhya Pradesh

U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 1991

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

94. Where is the famous Virupaksha temple located?

- (a) Bhadrachalam (b) Chidambaram
(c) Hampi (d) Srikalahasti

I.A.S. (Pre) 2009

Ans. (c)

The Virupaksha Temple is located at Hampi, in the state of Karnataka. This temple is devoted to Lord Shiva, who is known as Virupaksha here.

95. The Nagara, the Dravida and the Vesara are :

- (a) The three main racial groups of the Indian subcontinent.
(b) The three main linguistic divisions into which the languages of India can be classified.
(c) The three main styles of Indian temple architecture.
(d) The three main musical gharanas were prevalent in India.

I.A.S. (Pre) 2012

I.A.S. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (c)

The Nagara, Dravida and Vesara are three main styles of temple architecture. In these, the Dravida style of the temple construction was developed in South India while the Nagara style of temple construction was developed in North India. Vesara style is a mixture of Nagara and Dravidian styles.